

Survey Readiness Checklist

Mock Survey & Inspector Walkthrough Simulation

Product: Ambulatory Surgery Center Compliance Manual — Tier 1

Version: 1.0

Applicable Standards: CMS Conditions for Coverage (42 CFR Part 416), AAAHC Standards, State Licensure Requirements

Purpose

This document simulates an official accreditation survey. Use it to conduct internal mock surveys that replicate the methodology, sequencing, and scrutiny of CMS and AAAHC surveyors. Identify deficiencies before the real survey team does.

How Real Surveys Work

Survey Element	CMS Survey	AAAHC Survey
Notice	Unannounced (typically)	Scheduled (60–90 day window)
Duration	1–2 days	1–2 days
Team Size	1–3 surveyors	1–2 surveyors (peer-based)
Method	Tracer methodology (follow the patient)	Standards-based with tracer elements
Focus Areas	Patient safety, infection control, surgical services, environment	Quality, governance, clinical records, patient rights
Outcome	Compliance / Deficiency citations	Accreditation / Recommendations

Mock Survey Instructions

1. **Schedule a full day** — block OR cases if possible
2. **Assign a “surveyor” role** — ideally someone NOT involved in daily operations (consultant, colleague from another facility, or your most detail-oriented staff member)
3. **Follow this checklist sequentially** — it mirrors the actual survey flow
4. **Document every finding** — use the scoring system below
5. **Photograph deficiencies** — visual evidence drives accountability
6. **Complete the Summary Report** at the end (Section 10)

Scoring System

Score	Meaning	Action Required
 Compliant	Meets all requirements	Document as compliant; maintain
 Partial	Minor gap; easily correctable	Corrective action within 30 days
 Non-Compliant	Significant gap; would be cited	Immediate corrective action required
 Immediate Jeopardy	Patient safety risk	Stop operations if necessary; correct immediately

Section 1: Pre-Survey Documentation Review

Surveyors typically request documents before or at the start of the walkthrough. Have these ready in an organized binder or digital system.

1.1 Administrative Documents

#	Docu- ment	CMS Ref- erence	Avail- able?	Current?	Score	Notes
1	State License (current, posted)	State Re- quirements	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	CMS Certi- fication / Medicare Provider Agreement	§416.1	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	CLIA Certi- ficate (if lab ser- vices per- formed)	CLIA	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	DEA Regis- tration (current, posted)	DEA	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Organiza- tional Chart	§416.41	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	Governing Body Bylaws	§416.41	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Governing Body Meet- ing Minutes (last 12 months)	§416.41	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	Transfer Agreement (or physi- cian priv- ilege docu- mentation)	§416.41(b)	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
9		§416.41	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Docu- ment	CMS Ref- erence	Avail- able?	Current?	Score	Notes
	Disclosure of Owner- ship					
10	Profession- al Liability Insurance (facility)	General	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		

1.2 Policy & Procedure Manuals

#	Policy Area	CMS Reference	On File?	Current (re-viewed within 12 months) ?	Staff Aware?	Score	Notes
1	Patient Rights	§416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Infection Control	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Medication Management	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Surgical Services	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Anesthesia Services	§416.42(b)	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	Emergency Preparedness	§416.54	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Quality Assessment (QAPI)	§416.43	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	Medical Records	§416.47	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
9	Credentialing & Privileging	§416.45	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Environment of Care / Safety	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Policy Area	CMS Reference	On File?	Current (re-viewed within 12 months) ?	Staff Aware?	Score	Notes
11	HIPAA Privacy & Security	HIPAA	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Grievance / Complaint Process	§416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
13	Informed Consent	§416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
14	Advance Directives	§416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		
15	Discharge Planning	§416.52	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No		

1.3 Credentialing Files (Review 100% of provider files)

Pro- vider Name	Li- cense Cur- rent?	DEA Cur- rent?	Board Cert Veri- fied?	Mal- prac- tice Cur- rent?	NPDB Query (with- in 2 yrs)?	Priv- ilege Delin- eation on File?	Peer Refer- ences?	Ap- plicati on Com- plete?	Score
	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N ☐ N/ A	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N ☐ N/ A	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N ☐ N/ A	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N ☐ N/ A	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N ☐ N/ A	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	
	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N ☐ N/ A	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	

Section 2: Facility Entrance & Reception Area

Begin the walkthrough as a surveyor would — at the front door.

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	Facility signage visible and accurate	State	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Patient Rights notice posted in visible location	\$416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Non-discrimination notice posted	\$416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Grievance procedure notice posted or available	\$416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Advance directive information available	\$416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	State license posted and current	State	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	ADA accessibility — entrance, restrooms, common areas	ADA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	Reception area clean and orderly	\$416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
9	Emergency exits clearly marked from reception	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Fire extinguisher visible, inspec-	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
	ted (current tag)				
11	HIPAA privacy — patient conversations not overheard	HIPAA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Sign-in process protects patient identity	HIPAA	☐ Yes ☐ No		

Section 3: Pre-Operative / Admitting Area

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	Pre-op area clean with appropriate infection control signage	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Hand hygiene supplies at point of care (soap, sanitizer)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	PPE readily available (gloves, masks, gowns)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Pre-operative assessment documentation complete	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Informed consent signed, specific to procedure and anesthesia	§416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	H&P on chart (within 30 days; update within 24 hours of procedure)	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Patient identity verified (two identifiers)	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	Surgical site marked	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
	(when applicable per policy)				
9	Allergies documented and visible	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	NPO status verified and documented	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
11	IV access and fluids per order	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Patient privacy maintained (curtains, doors)	§416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No		
13	Call light / nurse call system functional	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
14	Clean and soiled linen separation	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
15	Sharps containers available, not overfull	OSHA / §416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		

Section 4: Operating Room(s)

Inspect each OR separately. Duplicate this section for multiple ORs.

OR #: _

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
Environment					
1	OR clean (floors, walls, ceiling, lights, vents)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Temperature and humidity within range and logged	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Positive air pressure maintained (or per design)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Air exchange rate meets minimum (15 ACH recommended)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	No visible damage to walls, floors, or ceiling tiles	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	All surfaces cleanable (no porous materials exposed)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Equipment					
7	Anesthesia machine — current PM sticker, daily checkout completed	§416.42(b)	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
8	Patient monitor — functional, alarms set	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
9	Electrosurgical unit — current calibration, grounding pad available	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Surgical lights — functional, backup available	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
11	OR table — functional, safety straps available	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Suction — functional, backup available	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
13	Emergency power — outlets marked, tested	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Infection Control					
14	Surgical hand scrub supplies adequate	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
15	Sterile supply storage appropriate (off floor,	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
	covered, in date)				
16	Sterilization indicators visible on sterile packs	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
17	No opened/undated sterile supplies	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
18	Trash and biohazard waste properly segregated	OSHA / §416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
19	Traffic patterns appropriate (clean to dirty flow)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Safety					
20	Fire extinguisher accessible and current inspection tag	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		
21	Emergency exit route posted	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		
22	Laser safety precautions in place (if applicable)	ANSI / OSHA	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A		
23	Electrical panel access clear (36-inch clearance)	NFPA 70	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
24	No prohibited items (food, drinks, personal items)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
Surgical Process (observe or verify via records)					
25	Time-out performed before incision (per Universal Protocol)	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
26	Surgical count performed and documented	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
27	Specimen handling per policy	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
28	Operative report dictated/completed promptly	§416.47	☐ Yes ☐ No		

Section 5: Sterile Processing / Decontamination Area

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	Physical separation between dirty and clean areas	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	One-way workflow (dirty → clean → sterile) maintained	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Adequate ventilation (negative pressure in decontam, positive in clean)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	PPE available and used in decontamination area	OSHA / §416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Enzymatic cleaner per manufacturer IFU	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	Ultrasonic cleaner tested (cavitation test current)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Instrument IFU (Instructions for Use) on file for all reprocessed items	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	Sterilizer PM current	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
9	Biological indicator (BI) log current — results documented	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Last BI failure — documented corrective action taken	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A		
11	Chemical indicators used inside and outside packs	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Sterilization load records maintained	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
13	Sterile storage appropriate (covered, off floor, climate-controlled)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
14	No expired sterile supplies in storage	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
15	Event-related sterility per policy (package integrity check before use)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
16	Staff competency documentation for sterile pro-	§416.46	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
	cessing personnel				
17	Single-use devices NOT being reprocessed (unless per FDA-cleared reprocessor)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
18	High-level disinfection log current (for semi-critical items)	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		

Surveyor Red Flag: Infection control in sterile processing is the #1 area where ASCs receive Immediate Jeopardy citations. A single observation of break in sterile technique can trigger an IJ finding.

Section 6: PACU / Recovery Area

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	Adequate nurse staffing for patient volume	§416.46	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Continuous monitoring capability (SpO2, ECG, BP)	§416.42(b)	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Emergency equipment immediately accessible (O2, suction, Ambu bag)	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Crash cart present, sealed, daily check log current	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Defibrillator present and functional (test log current)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	Malignant hyperthermia supplies accessible (Dantrolene, ice, etc.)	§416.42(b)	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Post-anesthesia assessment documented (Aldrete or equivalent scoring)	§416.42(b)	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
8	Discharge criteria policy in place and followed	§416.52	☐ Yes ☐ No		
9	Physician discharge order documented	§416.52	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Discharge instructions given and documented (patient/responsible adult)	§416.52	☐ Yes ☐ No		
11	Responsible adult present at discharge (when required)	§416.52	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Post-op follow-up instructions documented	§416.52	☐ Yes ☐ No		
13	Pain management documented	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
14	PONV (post-op nausea/vomiting) management documented	§416.42	☐ Yes ☐ No		
15	Privacy maintained between patient bays	§416.50	☐ Yes ☐ No		
16	Hand hygiene sup-	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
	plies at each bay				

Section 7: Medication Storage Areas

Inspect ALL areas where medications are stored — OR, PACU, med room, anesthesia carts, crash carts.

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	All medications within expiration date	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Medications stored per manufacturer requirements	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Refrigerated medications: temp log daily, range 36-46°F (2-8°C)	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Controlled substances double-locked	§416.48 / DEA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Controlled substance count log current and accurate	§416.48 / DEA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	Controlled substance discrepancy policy in place	§416.48 / DEA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Multi-dose vials labeled with date opened and expiration (28 days)	§416.48 / §416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	No single-dose vials being used	§416.51	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	CMS Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
	for multiple patients				
9	Look-alike/sound-alike medications separated or flagged	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Emergency medications (crash cart) current — not expired	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
11	Medication storage areas locked when unattended	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Medication waste (non-controlled) per policy	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
13	Anesthesia cart medications organized and labeled	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No		
14	Sample medications stored and documented per policy (if applicable)	§416.48	☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A		

Common Citation: Multi-dose vials without a “date opened” label are one of the most frequently cited medication deficiencies. Also — single-dose vials used on more than one patient (even from the same vial) is an Immediate Jeopardy finding.

Section 8: Life Safety & Physical Environment

8.1 Fire Safety & Egress

#	Inspection Point	Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	Fire alarm system tested and current (annual inspection report on file)	NFPA 72	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Fire sprinkler system inspected (annual report on file)	NFPA 25	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Fire extinguishers — current annual inspection and monthly visual check	NFPA 10	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Fire drills documented (quarterly minimum)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Exit signs illuminated and visible from all corridors	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	Emergency lighting functional (test monthly, full test annually)	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Egress paths clear (no storage, no obstructions)	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
8	Fire doors close and latch properly	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		
9	Smoke detectors functional (tested per schedule)	NFPA 72	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Evacuation plan posted (each floor / department)	NFPA 101	☐ Yes ☐ No		
11	Staff can articulate RACE and PASS procedures	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	No fire hazards observed (overloaded outlets, extension cords as permanent wiring, blocked panels)	NFPA 70	☐ Yes ☐ No		

8.2 Emergency Systems

#	Inspection Point	Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	Emergency generator present and functional	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	Generator tested weekly (log current)	NFPA 110	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	Annual load test completed and documented	NFPA 110	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Automatic transfer switch (ATS) functional	NFPA 110	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Emergency power outlets identified (red outlets)	NFPA 99	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	Medical gas system — current annual inspection	NFPA 99	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Medical gas zone valves accessible and labeled	NFPA 99	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	Medical gas alarms functional	NFPA 99	☐ Yes ☐ No		
9	Oxygen storage per code (separation from flammable materials)	NFPA 99	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
10	Emergency preparedness plan current (updated annually)	§416.54	☐ Yes ☐ No		
11	Emergency communication plan documented	§416.54	☐ Yes ☐ No		
12	Emergency supply inventory adequate and current	§416.54	☐ Yes ☐ No		

8.3 General Environment

#	Inspection Point	Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
1	Facility clean overall (floors, walls, ceilings, vents)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
2	No water stains, leaks, or moisture damage	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
3	HVAC system maintained (filter change records, temperature logs)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
4	Pest control program in place (contract current)	§416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		
5	Hazardous materials stored and labeled per SDS / OSHA	OSHA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
6	SDS (Safety Data Sheets) accessible to all staff	OSHA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
7	Biohazardous waste storage and pickup per regulations	OSHA / State	☐ Yes ☐ No		
8	Electrical panels — 36-inch clearance, labeled	NFPA 70	☐ Yes ☐ No		

#	Inspection Point	Reference	Compliant?	Score	Notes
9	No unapproved space heaters or personal appliances	NFPA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
10	Staff restrooms clean and supplied	OSHA	☐ Yes ☐ No		
11	Patient restrooms accessible, clean, with call device	ADA / §416.44	☐ Yes ☐ No		

Section 9: Staff Interview Preparation

Surveyors will interview staff at all levels. They ask questions designed to determine whether staff understand their roles, the facility's policies, and how to respond to emergencies. Prepare your team with these common questions.

9.1 Questions for ALL Clinical Staff

#	Question	Expected Response Elements	Staff Member Tested	Adequate?
1	"What do you do if there's a fire?"	RACE: Rescue, Alarm, Contain, Extinguish/Evacuate. PASS: Pull, Aim, Squeeze, Sweep. Know fire alarm pull station location. Know evacuation route.		☐ Yes ☐ No
2	"Where is the crash cart and how do you activate the emergency response?"	Location, how to call for help, BLS/ACLS role, who leads the code		☐ Yes ☐ No
3	"What are the steps for surgical site identification?"	Time-out procedure, two patient identifiers, surgical site marking, Universal Protocol		☐ Yes ☐ No
4	"How do you handle a blood/body fluid exposure?"	Immediate wound care, report to supervisor, incident report, post-exposure prophylaxis process		☐ Yes ☐ No
5	"What is your hand hygiene policy?"	5 moments of hand hygiene, soap vs. sanitizer, duration, when gloves are required		☐ Yes ☐ No
6	"How do you report a patient	Process for receiving, documenting, and es-		☐ Yes ☐ No

#	Question	Expected Response Elements	Staff Member Tested	Adequate?
	complaint or grievance?"	calating complaints; who to contact		
7	"What is your role in infection control?"	Personal responsibilities, reporting infections/exposures, standard precautions		☐ Yes ☐ No
8	"How do you identify a patient before medication administration?"	Two identifiers (name + DOB), allergy check, right patient-right drug-right dose-right route-right time		☐ Yes ☐ No
9	"Where is the Safety Data Sheet (SDS) binder and how do you access it?"	Physical location and/or electronic access; what to do for chemical exposure		☐ Yes ☐ No
10	"What do you do if you suspect a malignant hyperthermia reaction?"	Recognize signs (rising temp, rigidity, tachycardia), call for MH cart, Dantrolene administration protocol, MH hotline number		☐ Yes ☐ No

9.2 Questions for Nursing / Clinical Leadership

#	Question	Expected Response Elements	Staff Member Tested	Adequate?
1	"Describe your QAPI program and current projects."	Active projects, data collection method, how improvements are measured, governing body involvement		☐ Yes ☐ No
2	"How do you monitor infection rates?"	Surveillance methodology, reporting process, benchmarking, corrective actions taken		☐ Yes ☐ No
3	"What is your process for credentialing a new physician?"	Application, primary source verification, privilege delineation, governing body approval, provisional period		☐ Yes ☐ No
4	"How do you ensure staff competency?"	Orientation, annual competency assessment, skills validation, continuing education tracking		☐ Yes ☐ No
5	"Describe your discharge criteria."	Scoring system used, required vital sign stability, who authorizes discharge, responsible adult requirement,		☐ Yes ☐ No

#	Question	Expected Response Elements	Staff Member Tested	Adequate?
		written instructions		

9.3 Questions for Administrative / Front Desk Staff

#	Question	Expected Response Elements	Staff Member Tested	Adequate?
1	"How do you protect patient privacy?"	HIPAA basics, sign-in sheet protection, phone conversation discretion, who can access records		☐ Yes ☐ No
2	"What do you do if a patient presents with a complaint about their care?"	Listen, document, escalate to clinical leadership, provide grievance form if requested		☐ Yes ☐ No
3	"What is your role during a fire alarm?"	Know evacuation responsibilities, assist patients if trained, know exit routes, assembly point		☐ Yes ☐ No
4	"How do you verify patient identity at check-in?"	Photo ID, two identifiers, insurance verification process		☐ Yes ☐ No

9.4 Interview Coaching Tips for Small Teams

1. **Don't memorize scripts** — surveyors can tell. Understand the why behind each policy
2. **It's OK to say "I'd look it up in our policy manual"** — surveyors want to know you know WHERE to find the answer
3. **Never say "I don't know" and leave it there** — always add what you WOULD do ("I would contact my supervisor" or "I would reference our emergency protocol binder")

4. **Be honest** — if you haven't done a fire drill this quarter, don't lie. It's worse to be caught in a false statement
5. **Show your documentation** — if a surveyor asks about infection control, walk them to your IC binder. Physical demonstration builds confidence
6. **Every staff member matters** — housekeeping, front desk, and clinical staff are all fair game for interviews

Section 10: Mock Survey Summary Report

Facility Information

Field	Details
Facility Name	
Survey Date	
Surveyor(s)	
Areas Inspected	
Survey Duration	

Overall Scoring Summary

Section	Total Items	 Compliant	 Partial	 Non-Compliant	 Imm. Jeopardy	Compliance Rate
1. Documentation Review						%
2. Entrance & Reception						%
3. Pre-Op Area						%
4. Operating Room(s)						%
5. Sterile Processing						%
6. PACU / Recovery						%
7. Medication Storage						%
8. Life Safety & Environment						%
9. Staff Interviews						%
TOTAL						%

Findings Requiring Immediate Action (● and ✕)

Find- ing #	Sec- tion	De- scrip- tion	CMS Refer- ence	Sever- ity	Cor- rective Action	Re- spons- ible Party	Due Date	Status
1				☐ ● ☐ ✕				☐ Open ☐ In Pro- gress ☐ Closed
2				☐ ● ☐ ✕				☐ Open ☐ In Pro- gress ☐ Closed
3				☐ ● ☐ ✕				☐ Open ☐ In Pro- gress ☐ Closed
4				☐ ● ☐ ✕				☐ Open ☐ In Pro- gress ☐ Closed
5				☐ ● ☐ ✕				☐ Open ☐ In Pro- gress ☐ Closed

Findings Requiring Follow-Up (⚠️)

Finding #	Section	Description	CMS Reference	Corrective Action	Responsible Party	Due Date	Status
1							☐ Open ☐ In Progress ☐ Closed
2							☐ Open ☐ In Progress ☐ Closed
3							☐ Open ☐ In Progress ☐ Closed
4							☐ Open ☐ In Progress ☐ Closed
5							☐ Open ☐ In Progress ☐ Closed

Top 10 Deficiency Areas in ASC Surveys (National Data)

Use this list to prioritize your preparation. These are the most commonly cited deficiencies across ASC surveys nationally:

Rank	Deficiency Area	CMS Tag	What Surveyors Find
1	Credentialing & Privileging	§416.45	Incomplete provider files, missing NPDB queries, expired licenses
2	Infection Control — Sterile Processing	§416.51	Break in sterile technique, missing BI logs, IFU not followed
3	Pharmaceutical Services	§416.48	Expired medications, multi-dose vials undated, controlled substance documentation gaps
4	Medical Records	§416.47	Incomplete operative reports, missing H&P updates, unsigned orders
5	Patient Rights	§416.50	Informed consent incomplete, advance directive policy not implemented, grievance process unclear
6	QAPI Program	§416.43	No active performance improvement projects, data not collected, governing body not involved
7	Environment of Care	§416.44	Fire drill gaps, generator testing gaps, equipment PM overdue
8	Surgical Services	§416.42	Time-out not documented, H&P not within 30 days, discharge criteria not met
9	Governing Body	§416.41	Transfer agreement expired, meeting

Rank	Deficiency Area	CMS Tag	What Surveyors Find
			minutes incomplete, bylaws outdated
10	Emergency Preparedness	\$416.54	Plan not updated annually, drill not conducted, communication plan missing

Next Mock Survey Scheduled: ____

Recommended Frequency: Conduct a full mock survey quarterly. Conduct focused mini-mocks monthly on your weakest areas.

Document Version Control

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	Initial Release	ASC Compliance Team	Original mock survey document

This document is part of the ASC Compliance Manual — Tier 1: Essential Compliance Package (\$97). For the complete system including staff training matrices, policy templates, and quarterly update frameworks, upgrade to Tier 2: Complete Certification System (\$197).